The 7-Day Aged Lead Follow-Up Cadence

A Day-by-Day Multi-Channel Plan to Convert Aged Leads Into Appointments

From HowToWorkLeads.com — The Aged Lead Playbook

Why This Cadence Works

Most agents make one call, leave one voicemail, and move on. That's a 1-touch approach in a world that requires 5-12 touches. This cadence uses three channels — phone, text, and email — across seven days to maximize your contact rate and position you as a professional, not a spammer.

Rules of the cadence:

- Never skip a day (consistency beats intensity)
- Always personalize with the prospect's name and their original inquiry
- Vary the time of day across the week
- If they respond at any point, shift to a conversational flow — stop the cadence

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INSURANCE VERSION

Day 1 — Call + Voicemail + Text (10:00 AM local)

Call Script:

> *"Hi [Name], this is [Your Name] with [Company]. I'm calling because you looked into [life insurance / health coverage / Medicare] a little while back. I wanted to check — did you ever find the right plan, or is that still on your list?"*

Voicemail (if no answer):

> *"Hey [Name], this is [Your Name] with [Company]. I'm reaching out because you inquired about [insurance type] a while ago. I'm not sure if you got that handled, but I had a couple of options that might save you some money. I'll send you a quick text with my info — feel free to call or text me back at [number]. Talk soon."*

Text (immediately after voicemail):

> *"Hi [Name], this is [Your Name] from [Company]. I just left you a voicemail about the [insurance type] you looked into. No pressure — just wanted to see if you still need help finding the right plan. Text me back anytime."*

Day 2 — Email (8:00 AM local)

Subject line: "Quick question about your [insurance type] search"

Body:

> *Hi [Name],*
>
> *I tried reaching you yesterday — I know you looked into [life insurance / health coverage / Medicare options] a while back, and I wanted to see if you ever found what you were looking for.*
>
> *If you're still exploring, I'd love to run a quick comparison for you. Most people I work with find a plan that saves them $30-50/month in about 10 minutes.*
>
> *No obligation — just reply to this email or call/text me at [number].*
>
> *Best, [Your Name] [Company] [Phone]*

Day 3 — Call Only (4:30 PM local)

Script (different angle):

> *"Hi [Name], this is [Your Name] — I reached out a couple of days ago about [insurance type]. I know you're busy so I'll be quick: I've been helping people in [their area/state] find better rates this month, and I wanted to make sure you didn't miss out. Do you have 2 minutes?"*

If voicemail: Hang up. No message today — you'll text tomorrow. Leaving a voicemail every day feels pushy; strategic silence creates curiosity.

Day 4 — Text Message (11:00 AM local)

> *"Hey [Name], just checking in. I've been able to save most folks in [state/area] around $30-50/mo on their [insurance type] coverage. Worth a quick look? I can send you a no-obligation quote. Just reply YES and I'll get it started."*

Day 5 — Email (9:00 AM local)

Subject line: "Saved [Client first name] $47/month — thought of you"

Body:

> *Hi [Name],*
>
> *I just helped a client in [state/city] save $47/month on their [insurance type] coverage by switching to a plan that actually fit their situation better. It took us about 15 minutes.*
>
> *I don't know if you're still looking, but if you are, I'd be happy to do the same comparison for you — no cost, no pressure.*
>
> *Reply here or text me at [number].*
>
> *[Your Name]*

Day 6 — Call + Voicemail (12:00 PM local)

Voicemail:

> *"Hi [Name], it's [Your Name] from [Company] — this is my last call on this. I've been trying to reach you about the [insurance type] you looked into, and I don't want to be a pest. If you found coverage already, great — I'm happy for you. If not, my number is [number] and I can still get you a free comparison. Either way, I wish you the best. Take care."*

Note: The "last call" positioning is powerful. It removes pressure and often triggers a callback because people feel the window closing.

Day 7 — Break-Up Email (8:00 AM local)

Subject line: "Closing your file"

Body:

> *Hi [Name],*
>
> *I've reached out a few times about the [insurance type] coverage you were looking into, and I haven't heard back — which is totally fine. Everyone's on their own timeline.*
>
> *I'm going to close out your file on my end, but if anything changes down the road — rates go up, your situation changes, or you just want a second opinion — I'm here. Just reply to this email.*
>
> *Wishing you all the best, [Your Name] [Company] [Phone]*

Why "closing your file" works: It's the single highest-response email in most follow-up sequences. The fear of missing out on a resource (you) triggers replies from prospects who were on the fence.

MORTGAGE VERSION

Day 1 — Call + Voicemail + Text (10:00 AM local)

Call Script:

> *"Hi [Name], this is [Your Name] with [Company]. I'm reaching out because you inquired about [a mortgage / refinancing / home purchase] a while back. I know the market's been moving — are you still looking, or did you already get that taken care of?"*

Voicemail:

> *"Hey [Name], it's [Your Name] with [Company]. I'm calling about the [mortgage / refi] inquiry you made a while ago. Rates have shifted since then, and I wanted to see if it's worth a quick conversation to see where you stand. I'll text you my info — call or text me back at [number] whenever it's convenient."*

Text:

> *"Hi [Name], it's [Your Name] from [Company]. Just left you a voicemail about your mortgage inquiry. Rates have changed since you first looked — happy to run updated numbers for you if you're still interested. Text me back anytime."*

Day 2 — Email (8:00 AM local)

Subject line: "Rates have changed since you last looked"

Body:

> *Hi [Name],*
>
> *I tried reaching you yesterday about the [home purchase / refinance] you were exploring. Since you first inquired, rates have moved and some new programs have opened up.*
>
> *I'd love to spend 5 minutes running updated numbers for you — no application needed, no commitment. Most people are surprised by what they qualify for right now.*

> *Reply here or call/text me at [number].*
>
> *[Your Name] [Company] | NMLS #[number]*

Day 3 — Call Only (4:30 PM local)

Script:

> *"Hi [Name], this is [Your Name] calling back about your mortgage inquiry. I'll be quick — I ran some preliminary numbers based on what you were looking for, and I think there might be a better option than what was available before. Do you have a couple of minutes?"*

If voicemail: Hang up. No message today.

Day 4 — Text Message (11:00 AM local)

> *"Hey [Name], quick update — I've been able to get some of my clients in [state] into rates lower than what was available when you first inquired. Want me to run your numbers? Takes about 5 min, no commitment. Just reply YES."*

Day 5 — Email (9:00 AM local)

Subject line: "Helped [first name] save $312/month on their mortgage"

Body:

> *Hi [Name],*
>
> *Last week I helped a [homebuyer/homeowner] in [area] lock in a rate that saved them over $300/month compared to what they were originally quoted. The whole process took less than 30 days.*

> *I know timing is everything with mortgages. If you're still in the market — even casually — I'd love to run a quick scenario for you. No application, no hard pull on your credit, just numbers.*
>
> *[Your Name] [Company] | NMLS #[number] [Phone]*

Day 6 — Call + Voicemail (12:00 PM local)

Voicemail:

> *"Hi [Name], it's [Your Name] from [Company] — this is probably my last call on this. I've been trying to connect with you about your mortgage inquiry, and I completely understand if the timing isn't right. If you ever want to revisit it — whether that's next month or next year — just save my number: [number]. I specialize in finding the best rate for your situation, and that offer doesn't expire. Take care."*

Day 7 — Break-Up Email (8:00 AM local)

Subject line: "Closing your file, [Name]"

Body:

> *Hi [Name],*
>
> *I've tried connecting a few times about your [home purchase / refinance] inquiry. Since I haven't heard back, I'll go ahead and close your file.*
>
> *No hard feelings — I know mortgage timing is personal. But I want you to know: if rates drop, your situation changes, or you just want a second opinion on a quote you've gotten elsewhere, I'm a phone call away.*
>
> *Save my info and reach out whenever the time is right.*
>
> *[Your Name] [Company] | NMLS #[number] [Phone]*

After the 7-Day Cadence

Don't delete these leads. Move them into a long-term nurture:

Week	Action
Week 2	One email with valuable content (market update, tips)
Week 3	One text check-in
Week 4	One email with a case study or testimonial
Month 2-3	Monthly email newsletter
Month 3+	Quarterly personal check-in call

Key stat: 20-30% of aged lead conversions happen after the initial 7-day cadence, during the nurture phase. The agents who maintain a long-term drip on their aged lead database consistently outperform those who only work the first week.

Timing Cheat Sheet

Time of Day	Best For	Why
8:00 - 9:00 AM	Emails	Caught during morning inbox check
10:00 - 11:00 AM	Calls	People are awake, settled into their day
11:00 AM - 12:00 PM	Texts	Mid-morning, phone is nearby
4:00 - 5:30 PM	Calls	End of workday, more relaxed

Avoid: Before 8 AM, during lunch (12-1 PM), and after 8 PM. Weekends are fine for texts and emails but skip phone calls unless you're in a market where Saturday works well (real estate, solar).

Tracking Your Results

For every batch of aged leads, track these metrics:

- **Contact rate:** % of leads you actually spoke to (target: 10-15%)
- **Appointment rate:** % of contacts that booked a call/meeting (target: 20-30% of contacts)
- **Close rate:** % of appointments that became clients (target: 15-25%)
- **Cost per acquisition:** Lead cost / number of closed deals
- **Best-performing day/channel:** Which touchpoint generated the most responses?

Review weekly. Adjust scripts, timing, and channel mix based on what your data tells you.

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